Austen Chen

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Summary

BD + Partnerships leader and two-time founder with 10+ years of experience building technical, product-driven deals and first-of-kind partnership work. Seeking a role at a tech company focused on driving revenue growth, expanding product adoption, and providing a best-in-class customer + user experience.

Work Experience

Partner Solutions Architect + Engineer - Embedded Payroll | Gusto [Case Study] — Sept 2023 - July 2024

Payments platform enabling SMBs to pay employees, provide benefits, and ensure tax compliance.

- Advised enterprise partners like Chase + US Bank on integration best-practices by educating their EPD teams on payroll fundamentals, providing technical insights on backend API utilization, and frontend UI best practices.
- Built robust business cases with executive leadership by acting as the pre-sales technical SME building tailored demos, scoping phased build approaches, and projecting revenue lift from target ICPs. Resulted in $XXXk in ARR within 6 mos.
- Championed partners internally via feature requests and process improvements to ensure proper implementation timelines, successful pilot + GTM launches, and continuous alignment for upcoming feature releases + enhancements.
- Created AI-based resources for demo + troubleshooting to improve API documentation and cut triaging times by 30%.

Co-Founder & Head of Partnerships + Operations | Orihon — Nov 2019 - Apr 2025

Collective focused on creating recurring opportunities for artists within underserved communities.

- Represented over 50+ artists and connected them with government, corporate, and non-profit entities to explore new partnership and bespoke collection opportunities whilst advising on scalable business practices and tools.
- Continuously improved operational processes by driving new technology adoption, iterating on existing workflows, and implementing best practices to advance strategic initiatives, accelerate sales performance, and reduce costs by 18%.
- Established a first-of-kind collective connecting physical art installations with digital blockchains + NFTs (Ethereum, Solana, etc.) to expand artist reach, develop new fine arts programs, and drive art permanence within underserved locales.
- Selected for incubators like OnDeck Founder's Fellowship (ODF8) to gain networking and mentoring opportunities, learn foundational skills, and iterate on company business model / scope.

Senior Platform Marketing Manager | Autodesk [Case Study] — Nov 2021 - May 2022

Global leader in design and make technology spanning across architecture, manufacturing and media. * Left FTE - Family Care

- Defined platform GTM strategy by working directly with C-Suite to develop thought leadership content that emphasized cloud transformation, product + toolstack interoperability, and remote collaboration at scale for enterprise businesses.
- Led competitive analysis to identify new ICPs, assess TAM, and highlight key Autodesk differentiators which resulted in tailored content that ensured cohesiveness and alignment to overarching vertical-specific messaging (AEC, DM, ME).
- Owned platform content creation cross-functionally to influence + shape positioning, messaging frameworks, and value propositions for Autodesk's new platform focus and accompanying features, in close collaboration with Sales + Marketing.
- Helped create internal alignment across 15,000+ employees by integrating platform into FY23 OKRs and developing collateral focused on new ways for collaborative work, hybrid work models, and distributed teams.

Director of Strategic Partnerships + Operations | 2nd Address [Case Study] — Jan 2019 - Apr 2020

Online marketplace connecting traveling professionals with rental properties for long-term stays.

- Led Business + Product teams through a transition from an offline travel agency to an online, platform-oriented business model in order to create a differentiated offering, drive lower operational costs, and introduce cash flow positivity.
- Responsible for restructuring Sales strategy + brand identity, targeting new customer personas, and developing lean operations via product partnerships, lookalike modeling, and market insights, driving a 25% increase in revenue QoQ.
- Explored alternative revenue streams by assessing new markets + ICPs, developing first-of-kind partnerships, and examining customer + partner alignment to 2nd Address' product strengths in order to provide strategic direction + guidance.
- Overhauled Salesforce instance to improve KPI tracking, enable data-driven decision-making, and develop robust forecasting methodologies that generated +100% growth in booking volume and revenue within 6 months.

Director of Business Development | Singular [Case Study] — May 2016 - Dec 2018

Marketing intelligence platform unifying advertising spend via next-gen tracking and analysis. **Investors:** General Catalyst, Norwest Ventures

- Developed new extract, transform, and load (ETL) processes with FAANG and 1000+ other ad platforms for an end-to-end attribution and analytics product driving smarter ROI insights and faster marketing growth, leading to a $2m MRR lift.
- Established strong partnership foundations and constructed a globally distributed team of 10+ to advocate for additional data granularity, ensure GDPR + COPPA data compliance, and expand the reach of Singular's omni-channel ROI platform.
- Iterated on latest attribution trends like cross-device and multi-touch tracking by improving integrations with advertising channels to reduce overall cost per action (eCPAs) by over 20% for customers like Target, Walmart, and LinkedIN.
- Built proprietary integrations into ad network CDNs (Amazon S3, Google Cloud Platform, Microsoft Azure, etc.) to ingest ad units that enabled SIngular's Creative IQ product to optimize cross-network, resulting in a 18% lift in seat-based sales.

Senior Partnerships Manager | Chartboost [Case Study] — Jan 2013 - May 2016

Programmatic advertising platform and header bidding monetization for mobile games and apps. **Investors:** Sequoia Capital, SK Telecom

- Reported directly to Chartboost's Co-Founders to develop partner strategy and improve product adoption. Conceived and productized initatives like Creative Studio, Game Dev Advisory Board, and CPM Buyouts to produce a $3m ARR lift.
- Led all exploratory attribution and mediation (header bidding) partnerships which resulted in first-of-kind integrations with pioneering programmatic mobile advertising platforms like Admob (Google), Twitter (Mopub), AppLovin, and AppsFlyer.
- Pioneered Chartboost's first lead generation process to expand product adoption within new business opportunities, resulting in a 24% increase in penetration of applications in the Top 100 iOS, Android, and Amazon charts within 6 mos. time.
- Advised independent game developers on lean SDK implementation, product walkthroughs, and campaign optimization best practices to lift key metrics (CPA, eCPM, etc.) and ensure high peforming user acquisition + monetization.

Specialist + Genius Administrator | Apple — Jul 2009 - Jan 2013

- Consulted 75+ customers daily on product support and general technology topics to evangelize Apple's ecosystem.
- Collaborated with Operations to monitor + track service repair inventory levels, managed CRU + EOM paperwork, and properly documented storage. This included ordering replacement consumables and supervising the Repair Room ops.
- Prioritized repair queue for Geniuses and acted as the primary contact for customers, keeping them informed about repair statuses / summaries, managing / documenting internal case notes, and coordinating post-repair pickup processes.
- Chosen for an exclusive team focused on analyzing geographical data to improve accuracy + relevance in Apple Maps.

Co-Founder & Head of Operations + Marketing | Ergo Tedium — Jan 2009 - Sept 2011

Online retail company specializing in custom-designed apparel.

- Co-founded an online platform for customers to design and sell t-shirts with a variable revenue share between artists, Ergo Tedium, and charitable organizations. Company grew to 500+ unique customers with 1200+ fulfilled orders.
- Managed all social media channels to keep customers up to date on business events. Grew follower count on Twitter by 27% within first 3 months through social interaction, marketing campaigns + incentives, and local community engagement.
- Responsible for handling all customer service escalations in a timely manner, troubleshooting, and finding a resolution.

Education + Certifications

University of California, Davis - BA Psychology (Minor: Sociology) — 2012

ScrumAlliance - Certified ScrumMaster (ID#: 000437443) — 2015

Skillsets

- **Languages:** C++, Python, JavaScript, SQL, HTML / CSS, MacOS, iOS
- **Admin Exp:** Salesforce Sales + Marketing Cloud, Hubspot Sales + Marketing Hub, Google Workplace, Tableau
- **Soft Skillsets:** Contract Negotiation, Culture Development (DEI Rep @ Multiple Orgs), Effective Leadership, Executive Interfacing, Lean Operations, Platform Development, Product Operations, Resolving Ambiguity, Revenue Operations